Installing Ruby and Rails

At this point, your system will have Ruby installed, though it may not be the version you need to run Rails. You need Ruby 2.7.3 or higher. The 2.7.0p0 version that comes with Ubuntu 20.04 is *not* sufficient; it will produce segfaults when you attempt to run tests.

If you're comfortable upgrading your system's Ruby from a third-party respository, you can add the BrightBox repository:[22]

```
$ sudo apt-get install software-properties-common
$ sudo apt-add-repository ppa:brightbox/ruby-ng
$ sudo apt-get update
$ sudo apt-get upgrade
```

Note that BrightBox only contains up to to Ruby 2.7. If you want a later version of Ruby, or are concerned about there being unintended consequences to upgrading your system's Ruby, you can use rbenv[23] to install Ruby in parallel to your system Ruby. This also allows you to use many different versions of Ruby on the same computer but without disrupting the version of Ruby your system may depend on. rbenv is widely used for exactly this purpose. First, install it like so:

```
$ sudo apt install rbenv
$ rbenv init
```

Close your Terminal window and open a new one so your changes take effect. Verify that rbenv is properly set up using this rbenv-doctor script:

```
$ curl -fsSL \
    https://github.com/rbenv/rbenv-installer/raw/main/bin/rbenv-doctor \
    | bash -
```

If you're using another shell, consult the rbenv website for instructions if you aren't sure. Next, we'll install Ruby 3.1.3, the lastest version of Ruby 3.1 at the time of this writing:

```
$ rbenv install 3.1.3
```

This will take a long time, as it's downloading and compiling Ruby locally. Once